Rounds

Updated 12 Nov 2026. Rows marked Official were checked against berkeley.mt (event page, logistics post, archive). Rows marked 'verify' come from third-party listings.

Round	Type	Time	# Problems	Answer style	Content	Confidence	Source
Power Round	Team	90 min	Multi-part (varies)	Written proofs	One self-contained topic, usually undergraduate-level and unfamiliar from contests; the paper teaches definitions then asks for proofs of increasing difficulty	Official	berkeley.mt/events/bmt-2026 (official event page, via search)
Individual - General Test	Individual	90 min	25	Short answer	Algebra, geometry, discrete (counting, probability, number theory); no calculus. Easier than Focus; recommended for less experienced students	Official	berkeley.mt/events/bmt-2026 (official event page, via search)
Individual - Focus: Algebra	Individual	60 min	10	Short answer	Harder single-subject test; take exactly two Focus tests	Official	berkeley.mt/events/bmt-2026 (official event page, via search)
Individual - Focus: Geometry	Individual	60 min	10	Short answer	Harder single-subject test	Official	berkeley.mt/events/bmt-2026 (official event page, via search)
Individual - Focus: Discrete	Individual	60 min	10	Short answer	Combinatorics and number theory	Official	berkeley.mt/events/bmt-2026 (official event page, via search)
Individual - Focus: Calculus	Individual	60 min	10	Short answer	Limits, derivatives, integrals, series	Official	berkeley.mt/events/bmt-2026 (official event page, via search)
Guts Round	Team	75 min	27	Short answer, live scored	9 sets of 3; each set handed in before the next. Points per question by set: 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 16, 18, 21, 25. Set 9 is estimation, scored by closeness	Official	berkeley.mt/events/bmt-2026 (official event page, via search); berkeley.mt/archives (past papers)
Tiebreakers	Individual	Short	Few	Short answer	Only for top scorers tied in the Individual Round	Official	berkeley.mt/events/bmt-2026 (official event page, via search)

Scoring

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Topic	Rule	Confidence	Source
Individual tests	1 point per correct answer; no weighting among problems; no stated penalty for wrong answers	Official	berkeley.mt/events/bmt-2026-online (official, via search)
Individual rankings	Individuals are ranked only within the tests they chose	Official	berkeley.mt/events/bmt-2026-online (official, via search)
General vs Focus	For team scoring, the General Test counts for half as many points as a pair of Focus tests	Official	berkeley.mt/events/bmt-2026-online (official, via search)
Team score	A combination of the team's Power and Guts scores plus its members' Individual Round scores	Official	berkeley.mt/events/bmt-2026 (official event page, via search)
Team score weights	30% Power, 40% Individual, 30% Guts. Each test is normalised by the average of the top 10 scores or top 10% (whichever covers more)	Official	berkeley.mt/events/bmt-2026 (official event page, via search)
Tiebreaks (automatic)	Ties for top awards are broken by who solved the hardest problems (n-th hardest problem worth 2^-n). Remaining Individual ties go to a 15-min Tiebreaker: 5 questions (General) or 3 (Focus), scored on correctness then submission time	Official	berkeley.mt/events/bmt-2026 (official event page, via search)
Small teams	Fewer than 4 members: zeros fill in until there are 4 Individual scores	Official	berkeley.mt/events/bmt-2026 (official event page, via search)
Guts	Scored live set by set; points per question 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 16, 18, 21, 25 (max 420), unchanged 2023-2025	Official	berkeley.mt/archives (past papers)
Power	Graded on correctness and rigor of proofs; partial credit per part is usual. Rubric not found	Past-year pattern - verify	berkeley.mt/archives (past papers)

Choosing Your Test

Guidance, not an official rule. Coaches should balance the roster because General scores are worth half for the team.

If you...	Take	Why
Have not taken calculus and are in your first year or two of contests	General Test	Broad, more approachable problems; 25 chances to score
Are strong in two subjects and comfortable with AMC 12 / AIME-level problems	Two Focus tests	Double the team weight and a shot at subject awards
Are in or beyond AP Calculus BC and quick with integrals and series	Calculus + one other	Calculus Focus is the most 'learnable' test - techniques are standard
Like counting and number theory	Discrete + Algebra	The two overlap (generating functions, polynomials mod p, recursions)
Are a geometry specialist	Geometry + Algebra	Trig and complex-number methods serve both

Round Strategy

Coaching advice based on the published format.

Round	Tip	Detail
Power	Read the whole paper first	Split parts among teammates; earlier results may be cited in later proofs even if you did not prove them (check the cover page)
Power	Assign a scribe and a checker	Legible, complete proofs score; one person should reread every write-up for gaps
Power	Bank the easy parts	The first sections are definitions and warm-ups worth real points - finish them before chasing the last problem
Individual	Two passes	First pass: everything you can do in under 3 minutes. Second pass: return to the rest. All problems are worth the same
Individual	Simplify answers	Reduce fractions, rationalize where natural, give exact forms
Individual	Never leave blanks	No penalty for wrong answers has been stated, so guess
Guts	Split the three problems	One or two people per problem by strength; a second person checks before the runner submits
Guts	Watch the clock, not the scoreboard	About 8 minutes per set gets you through all 9; later sets are worth more, so do not sink 20 minutes into set 3
Guts	Have a plan for estimation	Agree in advance who does Fermi-style estimates; a rough answer still earns partial points
All	Know the room	Buildings are spread across campus; walk the route during check-in